RP12 Thin-Layer Chromatography – Knowledge Organiser

AQA A-level Chemistry • Set 1: Thin-Layer Chromatography **Paper 2**

#	Question	Answer
1	Stationary phase	Silica or alumina on a plate
2	Baseline drawn in	Pencil
3	Solvent level relative to baseline	Below
4	Why spots are small and concentrated	Give clear, separate spots
5	Why the plate is held by the edges	Avoid contamination
6	Why a lid is used	Saturates the atmosphere with solvent
7	When the plate is removed	Solvent near the top
8	What is marked on removal	Solvent front
9	R_f equation	Distance moved by spot ÷ distance moved by solvent
10	How a component is identified	Compare R_f with a known sample